

Pre-Travel Assessment Checklist

Purpose

General preparation guidance for travelers. This is not legal, immigration, medical, or government advice. Rules change, and travelers must confirm current requirements with official sources and their airline or transport carrier.

Information to Collect

Collect the following before assessing readiness:

- Destination country or territory
- Passport country / nationality
- Travel dates
- Transit countries and airports
- Passport expiry date
- Visa or travel authorization status
- Health documents, vaccinations, or entry health requirements
- Travel insurance status
- Emergency contacts and whether they are prepared and current
- Copies of key documents and whether they are prepared and accessible

If any essential details are missing, ask for them before finalizing the assessment.

Assessment Categories

Review each category separately:

Passport

- Passport validity for the destination and transit path
- Blank pages, condition, and whether passport validity extends beyond the trip dates by the officially verified destination-specific period

Visa and Travel Authorization

- Visa requirement
- Electronic travel authorization or entry pre-authorization
- Transit visa or transfer rules, including any transit documentation requirements

Destination Regulations

- Entry rules
- Customs requirements
- Biosecurity or restricted-item rules
- Transit-country customs, security, and transfer restrictions not covered by document checks

Health Preparation

- Vaccination or health document requirements
- Destination health advisories
- Medication documentation needs

Insurance and Assistance

- Travel insurance coverage
- Medical coverage
- Rebooking or assistance support

Emergency Preparation

- Emergency contact completeness
- Document-copy completeness
- Local support and embassy/consular contacts

Readiness Status

- **Ready:** No known blockers and all required items are confirmed or documented.
- **Needs attention:** Some items are incomplete, unclear, or need official verification promptly.
- **Not ready:** A blocker exists, or an essential requirement is missing or unresolved.

Urgency

- **Immediate:** Within 7 days or a blocker is present.
- **Soon:** Within 30 days or the item needs lead time to complete.
- **Plan ahead:** More than 30 days away and the item is preparatory.

Recommended Assessment Format

Use this structure for the final assessment:

1. Overall status
2. Confirmed items
3. Required actions
4. Urgency and timing
5. Official sources checked
6. Final-authority reminder

Official Sources to Prefer

Prefer official sources over blogs, forums, or social media:

- Destination immigration or border authority
- Destination foreign affairs ministry or equivalent
- Passport authority
- Transit-country immigration or border authority
- Travel advisory service
- Health authority
- Customs or biosecurity authority
- Airline, ferry, cruise, rail, or other operating carrier
- Insurer

Safety and Accuracy Guardrails

- Never guarantee entry.
- Never invent destination-specific rules.
- Never present unofficial guidance as final.
- Always remind the traveler that official verification is the final authority.